

The Beacon Centre — Admin Dashboard Guide

Everything the church app shows — devotionals, sermons, announcements, giving, community groups — is controlled from this dashboard. Nothing here requires technical knowledge. If you can fill in a form, you can run the app.

1. Signing in

Go to the dashboard address in any browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge — phone or computer).

You'll see **The Beacon Centre** with the logo, then a **Sign In** card asking for:

- **Email Address**
- **Password** — the eye icon on the right shows what you typed, if you want to check it

Press **Sign In**. You land on the Dashboard.

***First thing to do:** change the password you were sent. It was a temporary one.*

2. Finding your way around

The left sidebar is the menu. It lists every section. The section you're currently in is highlighted dark.

The top bar has a **Search content...** box, a **bell** for notifications, and your **name and initials** on the right — click it for **Settings** and **Sign out**.

On a phone the sidebar is hidden; tap the ☰ icon at the top left to open it.

What you can see depends on your role. Menu items you don't have permission for simply don't appear — nothing is broken if your menu is shorter than someone else's.

Role	What they can do
Super Admin	Everything, including creating and removing other admins
Admin	All content, giving, prayer and contact — but not admin management

Editor	Content only (devotionals, sermons, announcements, categories, collages)
CSG Admin	One assigned community group, nothing else

3. Devotionals

Menu: Devotionals — the daily devotional the app shows on its home screen and devotional page.

To add one, press **New Devotional** and fill in:

Field	Notes
Date	The day this devotional appears in the app
Title	e.g. "Light that doesn't flicker"
Verse Reference	Just the reference — e.g. <code>John 3:16</code> , <code>Psalms 23:1-3</code>
Verse Text	The verse written out in full
Main Content	The devotional itself. Leave a blank line between paragraphs — the app splits them into separate paragraphs
Prayer (optional)	A closing prayer, shown in its own box in the app

***Important:** if no devotional is set for a day, the app says "No devotional yet today" rather than showing something made up. The days you fill in are the days people see.*

4. Video Sermons

Menu: Video Sermons — videos come from YouTube. You don't upload the video file, you paste its link.

Press **Add Video Sermon** and paste the **YouTube URL** (`https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=...`). The dashboard reads the video automatically. Then fill in **Title**, **Speaker**, **Type** (Sermon, Excerpt or Inspirational), **Description**, **Category**, **Series** (leave blank if it isn't part of one) and **Tags** (separated by commas).

There is also **Add a Short** for the short vertical clips.

5. Audio Sermons

Menu: Audio Sermons — audio people can listen to and download in the app.

Press **Upload Audio Sermon**, choose the audio file, then fill in **Title**, **Speaker**, **Category**, **Sermon Date** (optional), **Description** (optional), and the **Featured Sermon** switch to push it to the top.

*Like devotionals, the app shows "No audio sermons yet" when this section is empty.
It no longer shows sample tracks.*

6. Announcements

Menu: Announcements — notices shown in the app's News section. Press **Create Announcement**:

Field	Notes
Title	
Content	The body of the notice
Priority Level	Higher priority shows more prominently
Start Date	When it begins appearing
Expiry Date (<i>optional</i>)	When it disappears by itself — useful for one-off events
Button Text (<i>optional</i>)	e.g. "Learn More", "Register Now"
Button URL (<i>optional</i>)	Where that button goes
Active Status	Switch it off to hide without deleting

You can also attach an image.

7. Categories

Menu: Categories — the labels used to group sermons and other content. Create them here first and they become selectable in the sermon forms.

8. Photo Collages

Menu: Photo Collages — picture sets from services and events, shown in the app's gallery. Press **New Collage**, give it a title, and add the photos.

9. Community Groups

Menu: Community Groups — the CSGs, with meeting details and location on the map. Press **New Community Group**:

Field	Example
Name	Youth Fellowship
Description	What the group is about
Meets On	Every Wednesday
Meeting Time	6:30 PM
Address	The meeting location
Latitude / Longitude (<i>optional</i>)	6.5244 / 3.3792 — for the map pin

Each group can be given its own **CSG Admin**, who can manage that group and nothing else.

10. Giving

Menu: Giving — three tabs across the top.

Transactions — every gift received, with purpose (tithe, offering, seed, project), amount and status. This is your record; deleting a project does not remove its past transactions.

Bank Accounts — the account details shown in the app for bank transfer. Add one with **Bank Name**, **Account Name**, **Account Number** and optional **Instructions**. In the app, people tap to copy the bank name and account number straight to their clipboard.

*Card giving through Paystack is currently marked **Coming soon** in the app, so bank transfer is the giving method people see.*

Projects — fundraising campaigns, each with a progress bar in the app. Press **New Project**:

Field	Notes
Title	e.g. "New Sanctuary Roof"
Short Blurb <i>(optional)</i>	One or two lines shown on the project card
Full Description <i>(optional)</i>	
Target Amount (₦)	
Deadline <i>(optional)</i>	
Image <i>(optional)</i>	

Progress is calculated automatically and shown read-only — you never type in how much has been raised.

To remove a project: press the red bin icon on its row. A confirmation appears naming the project, so you can check you picked the right one before confirming. Past giving stays in the ledger.

11. Prayer & Contact

Menu: Prayer & Contact — **Prayer Requests** submitted through the app, and **Contact Messages** sent from the contact form. Read them here and mark them as handled.

12. Push Notifications

Menu: Notifications — sends an alert to people's phones. Treat it with care; it interrupts everyone.

- **Audience** — who receives it. There's also a **topic** option, e.g. `announcements` , `live`
- **Title** — the bold line on the phone's lock screen
- **Message** — the body

Then **Send**. It goes immediately and cannot be recalled, so read it twice.

13. Analytics

Menu: Analytics — how the app is being used, and counts of what's published: devotionals, videos, audios, announcements.

14. Admin Management

Menu: Admin Management (*Super Admin only*) — create accounts for other people. Press **New Admin**:

Field	Notes
Email	
Password	Minimum 6 characters
Full Name	
Role	Super Admin, Admin, Editor or CSG Admin
Community Group	Only appears when the role is CSG Admin; that admin will only manage the group you pick
Active	Switch off to suspend an account without deleting it

Give people the smallest role that lets them do their job. An Editor cannot touch giving or admin accounts, which protects both them and you.

15. Settings

Menu: Settings — your own account details and church-wide settings, including changing your password.

Everyday rules of thumb

1. **Nothing is live until you save.** Closing a form without saving loses the changes.
2. **Empty means empty.** The app no longer invents placeholder content. If a section is blank in the dashboard, it's blank in the app.

3. **Deactivate rather than delete** where a switch exists — it's reversible.
 4. **Push notifications cannot be undone.** Read before sending.
 5. **Changes appear in the app on the next refresh** — pull down on the screen in the app to fetch fresh content.
-

If something looks wrong

Take a screenshot and send it over. Note which page you were on and what you'd just pressed — that's usually enough to find it straight away.